

County Council Budget Hearings 2025, Friday, September 12th, Session #2

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=24JWRtDwiUk
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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The meeting began directly with budget deliberations and work session discussions; no statutory public hearings or committee sessions were held immediately prior to the call to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order following a lunch recess by the presiding officer to resume county budget deliberations **00:00:17**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Council members including Matt, Jim, Bill, Brad, Eugene, and others explicitly participating in budget discussions.
 - **Other Officials Present:** Ed (Auditor), Stephen Brand (Commissioner), Kylene Swackmer (Planning Commission), Rick (Clerk), and Emily (Court/Judicial).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as the Council President.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not addressed during this portion of the session.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:18 Auditor's Budget Review & Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed (County Auditor) and Elizabeth (Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed multiple line items for the Auditor's office, including salary adjustments, elimination of a senior plat room deputy position, and re-evaluating overtime needs due to the county handbook's elimination of compensatory (comp) time. Discussion also covered office supply reimbursements for paper purchased in bulk, contractual services (including Baker Tilly and GAP compilation fees), and travel/training expenses.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to restore/adjust specific line items (e.g., \$5,000 for overtime, adjusted office supplies, and restored contractual services). Final adjusted auditor budget total recorded at \$1,29,462 with a total adjustment of -\$178,72.
- **00:14:00 County Health Insurance, Clinic Savings, & Commissioner Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Stephen Brand (County Commissioner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioners presented projected health insurance savings totaling \$850,000 (comprising \$360,000 from transitioning to a new Marathon health clinic and \$490,000 in premium/claim savings). The board also discussed housekeeping staff reductions (eliminating three part-time positions saving approximately \$60,000) and utility cost reviews (investigating cable TV and phone expenses).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to incorporate the \$850,000 health insurance savings and adjust commissioner salary/part-time lines (-\$73,026 total salary reduction, yielding adjusted totals of \$6,684,339 for the fund).
- **01:42:00 Maintenance Department Salary Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bill (Council Member) / Stephen Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Following identified budget savings by the commissioners, the board debated providing a \$1,000 salary increase to five maintenance/technician positions (reporting to Dawn/facilities) to recognize increased workloads and retention efforts.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to grant the \$1,000 salary increase to the five maintenance employees.
- **02:14:04 Planning Commission Budget & Salary Requests**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylene Swackmer (Planning Commission Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Swackmer presented the Planning Commission budget, noting that salaries and departmental costs are heavily offset (over 80% to over

100% via fringe calculations) by federal transportation reimbursements through the MPO. The office requested a 2% raise for staff and the executive director. Debates ensued regarding whether revenue-generating departments should receive raises while non-revenue departments face tighter restrictions.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to incorporate a 2% salary increase for Planning Commission staff and the executive director. Final planning commission budget adjusted to a total of \$643,616 (general) and \$37,682 (perpetuation).
 - **02:35:00 Recorder's Office Budget & Staffing**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Members and Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed raises for Recorder's office employees funded out of the office's document perpetuation fund rather than County General. The board agreed to a 2% raise for the three perpetuation fund employees.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to grant a 2% raise funded exclusively through the perpetuation fund.
 - **02:49:15 Clerk's Office End-of-Year Givebacks**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick (County Clerk).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Clerk appeared before the board to announce unspent 2025 funds being returned ("givebacks"), offering \$110,000 from contractual election/voting machine accounts and \$30,000 from part-time salary lines. The board also briefly touched on clerk/election staff comp time policies under the county handbook.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Accepted by Voice Vote as a voluntary operational return of unspent 2025 appropriations.
 - **02:57:23 Court / Judicial Part-Time Staffing Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily (Court Representative).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Emily requested additional part-time allocation (expanding a shared 2-day probation/2-day court position or adding a new part-time position) to assist with jury management and administrative court duties. Council members expressed reluctance to expand part-time lines without a broader staffing plan.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Failed / Denied by Voice Vote (additional part-time expansion not approved).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general public comment period was held; public participation during this session was strictly limited to elected officials, department heads, and board presenters.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The board scheduled an additional budget work session for **Monday at noon** to finalize remaining department figures ahead of the official budget adoption meeting on the 23rd **02:32:16**.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - The meeting was recessed/adjourned by voice consensus following the conclusion of scheduled department reviews **03:08:45**.
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